

Gautam Velpula

VP, Software Development & Platform Engineering

Consumer Platforms • Fintech • AI/ML • Global Engineering at Scale

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Executive Summary

Engineering and technology executive with extensive experience leading large, globally distributed teams building customer-facing platforms at scale. Deep expertise in payments, financial services, and consumer digital products. Proven track record modernizing legacy systems, consolidating multi-brand platform ecosystems, and driving AI adoption across engineering organizations. Combines executive presence and C-suite partnership with strong technical credibility to challenge assumptions, guide architectural direction, and deliver measurable business outcomes.

Professional Experience

GoTo Foods LLC

2021 – Present

Sr Director, Enterprise Architecture & Platform Engineering

- Served as the single architectural authority across a multi-brand consumer technology organization, guiding engineering direction for digital platforms, payments, marketing technology, and data — influencing outcomes across 200+ engineers and contractors.
- Defined and executed a unified digital platform consolidating 7 independent consumer-facing brand apps and websites, materially reducing development costs and accelerating feature delivery across the portfolio.
- Re-architected backend systems to a microservices and event-driven model processing high-volume real-time event streams, standardizing APIs, service contracts, and integration patterns across brands.
- Led payments platform integration with FreedomPay, enabling digital wallets, tokenization, and modern checkout experiences — directly supporting fintech-adjacent revenue growth.
- Architected and delivered a subscription service supporting new recurring-revenue business models, including hands-on technical intervention to stabilize the service during a critical legacy system failure.
- Championed enterprise-wide **AI and LLM adoption**: defined architectural patterns, guardrails, and best practices for safe, scalable usage across engineering teams.
- Led design and implementation of **agentic AI use cases** across consumer-facing products and internal systems, focused on automation, intelligent decision support, and operational efficiency.
- Embedded LLM capabilities into APIs, event-driven services, and internal tooling in partnership with engineering, data, and product teams — unlocking measurable productivity gains.
- Partnered with security and compliance to establish governance standards for AI-assisted development, balancing speed, cost, security, and reliability.
- Reduced time-to-market by approximately 40% and improved system uptime by approximately 30% through platform consolidation and architectural modernization.
- Built and led a senior architecture organization of principal and lead architects, fostering a culture of technical excellence and continuous improvement.

Slalom Consulting
Senior Delivery Principal

2018 – 2021

- Led multi-million-dollar digital transformation, cloud modernization, and payments initiatives for Fortune 500 clients in financial services, eCommerce, and consumer technology.
- Conducted a multi-year enterprise assessment of a legacy payments platform for one of the largest eCommerce companies in the U.S., defining the target-state architecture and modernization roadmap for processing at massive scale.
- Designed and delivered payment processing systems for a large financial services organization, including real-time transaction flows and compliance integration.
- Led a major cloud migration from on-premises and AWS to GCP for a leading point-of-sale and payments provider.
- Directed cross-functional, globally distributed teams spanning engineering, architecture, product, and design across multi-year engagements.
- Served as primary executive-facing delivery and technology advisor, translating business strategy into actionable engineering roadmaps for C-suite stakeholders.
- Achieved approximately 95% client satisfaction and repeat business across multiple multi-million-dollar engagements.
- Implemented Agile and DevOps operating models, increasing deployment frequency by approximately 30% and reducing lead time by approximately 25%.
- Mentored delivery leaders and principals, strengthening leadership depth and organizational delivery maturity.

Jacada (acquired by Uniphore)
Director, Professional Services

2014 – 2018

- Owned global professional services delivery for enterprise customers, leading large-scale implementations for Fortune 500 clients across multiple geographies.
- Held end-to-end accountability for delivery from pre-sales through post-implementation, managing distributed teams and complex integration programs.
- Acted as a trusted advisor to C-level stakeholders, aligning technology delivery with business objectives and driving organizational change.
- Served as the senior-most technical leader within services, providing architectural guidance, escalation support, and engineering direction.
- Built and scaled a global professional services organization through recruiting, training, and standardized delivery practices.
- Partnered with product management to influence product roadmap based on client needs and market insights.

Technology & Platform Expertise

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, Node.js, Java (Spring Boot), NestJS, Next.js, React Native, Scala (familiarity)

Cloud & Platform: Microsoft Azure (AKS, Front Door, API Management, Functions), Google Cloud Platform, Vercel, Cloudflare

Data & Messaging: Cosmos DB, Databricks, Event Hub, Service Bus, real-time event streaming

AI/ML: LLM integration patterns, agentic AI architectures, AI governance frameworks

Payments & Fintech: FreedomPay, tokenization, digital wallets, payment processing, PCI compliance

Analytics & Observability: GA4, Firebase, Splunk

Core Strengths

Consumer Platform Engineering at Scale • Payments & Fintech • AI/LLM Strategy & Adoption • Global Team Leadership • Platform Consolidation & Migration • C-Suite Partnership • Technical Credibility & Architectural Direction • Organization Building

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology George Mason University, Fairfax, VA	<i>2007 – 2009</i>
Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science Osmania University, Hyderabad, India	<i>2002 – 2006</i>